

MAY 2026

Milwaukee County Real Estate Market Report

April 2026 Data | Prepared: May 03, 2026

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Market Status

Transitioning to balanced — sellers still hold edge



Market Snapshot

April 2026 showed **steady sales** with rising inventory and extended marketing times. Closed sales up 0.7%, new listings surged 25.6%, and median price held firm at \$305,000.

Key Market Drivers

- Mortgage rates at 3-year lows: 6.30%
- Unemployment at historic low: 2.3–2.6%
- Wage growth of 4.5% YoY outpacing inflation
- Population growing ~3,000 residents/year

PRICE TRENDS

Median Sales Price: \$305,000

\$305K

Current Price

+1.7%

YoY Change

\$300K

Prior Year

For Buyers

- YTD median up 7.3% – act now
- Luxury segment (\$700K–\$1M)
up 140%

For Sellers

- Stable pricing supports
confident listing
- Entry-level sales up 58.8%

MARKET SPEED

Days on Market: 22 Days (Avg)

Median DOM

6

Days (unchanged YoY)

Avg DOM – Now

22

Days in April 2026

Avg DOM – Last Year

18

Days in April 2025

What This Means: Hot homes still move in days; overpriced listings linger. Budget 3–4 weeks on market.

Buyers

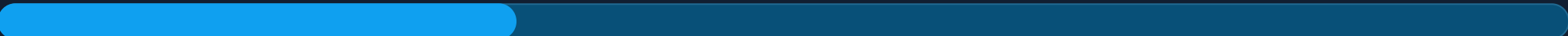
- More time to evaluate options
- Less pressure from bidding wars

Sellers

- Price right from day one
- Condition & staging matter more

Inventory & Months' Supply

Active listings: **1,126 units** (+27.2% YoY) | Months of supply: **2.0 months** (up from 1.6)



33%

Of Balanced Market

2.0 of 6.0 months – still seller-favorable

For Buyers

- More choices, especially \$100K–\$300K
- Inventory up 54% in entry-level range

For Sellers

- Market still favors sellers at 2.0 months
- Price competitively – competition rising

Sale-to-List Price Ratio: 100.7%

Homes are still selling **above list price**, but the ratio compressed from 101.7% last year — signaling less aggressive bidding and more normalized negotiations.

Why It Matters

A ratio above 100% means sellers still hold leverage. The 1-point drop reflects growing buyer options and moderating competition.

Market Implications

- **For Buyers:** More room to negotiate on inspections & closing costs
- **For Buyers:** Bidding wars less common — but not gone
- **For Sellers:** Still achieving above-ask on well-priced homes
- **For Sellers:** Overpricing now carries real risk

NEW SUPPLY

New Listings: 928 Homes

Year-Over-Year Change

+25.6%

Sellers responding to improved buyer financing and market confidence. Most growth in \$100K-\$300K range.

Why It Matters

- Highest listing volume since tracking began
- Pending sales up 32.3% — demand absorbing supply
- Strong pipeline heading into summer season

For Buyers

- More options across all price points
- Less urgency — but act on well-priced homes

For Sellers

- More competition — presentation is key
- 258 pending sales show demand is real

AFFORDABILITY

Affordability & Income Context

\$106K

Median HH Income

\$380K

Buying Power

At 28% DTI, 6.30% rate

\$305K

Median Price

23% below national median

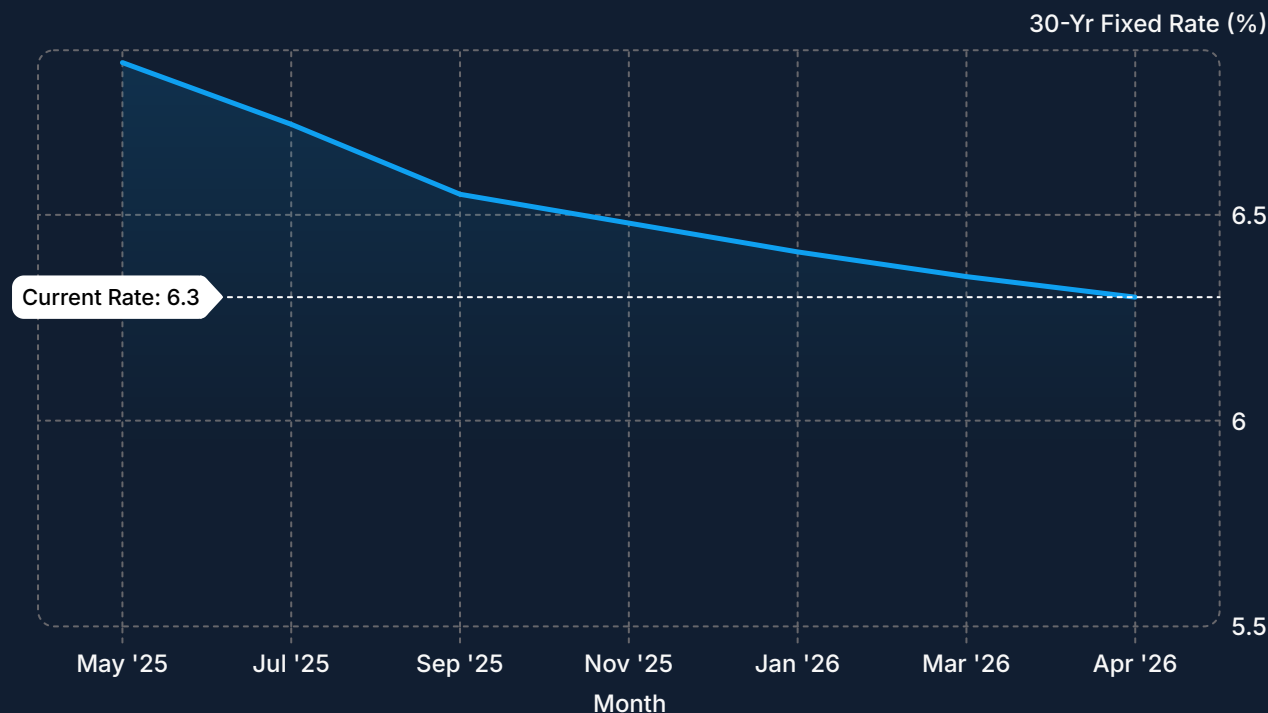
For Buyers

- Milwaukee 23% cheaper than national median (\$396,800)
- Income comfortably supports current prices

For Sellers

- Strong local wages sustain buyer demand
- Attractive to out-of-state relocations

Mortgage Rate Trend



Current Rate

6.30%

vs. Last Year

-57 bps

3-Year Low

Best affordability since March 2022

PAYMENT IMPACT

\$305K Payment Impact: Now vs. Last Year



April 2026 — 6.30%

P&I Payment: ~\$1,895/mo

On \$305,000 home, 30-yr fixed

April 2025 — 6.87%

P&I Payment: ~\$2,015/mo

On \$305,000 home, 30-yr fixed

~\$120

Monthly Savings

~\$1,440

Annual Impact

Single-Family Price-Point Breakdown

Price Band	Inventory (Mo.)	DOM	% of List	Closed Sales	Insight
<\$250K	1.2	8	101.5%	+58.8%	High demand, fast-moving
\$250K-\$350K	1.8	12	101.2%	+1.8%	Steady, most active range
\$350K-\$500K	2.4	18	100.8%	Mixed	Balanced, moderate pace
\$500K-\$700K	3.1	24	99.5%	+53.5%	Surging – rate-sensitive
\$700K-\$1M	4.2	32	98.2%	-29.2%	Volatile; pending +140%
\$1M+	5.8	45	97.1%	Declining	Buyer's market territory

Opportunities & Risks: Entry-level (<\$250K) remains fiercely competitive. Luxury (\$700K+) offers negotiating room but carries volatility risk.

What It Means: Buyers | Sellers



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For Buyers

- **Be Prepared:** Pre-approval is essential
- **Get Pre-Approved:** Lock rates at 3-yr lows
- **Act Quickly:** Under \$300K moves fast

For Sellers

- **Excellent Timing:** Demand remains strong
- **Price Correctly:** Overpricing = longer DOM
- **Present Well:** Staging is a differentiator

RapidStats Data Summary

Median Price

\$305,000

+1.7% YoY

Days on Market

22 days (avg)

+4 days YoY

Sale-to-List

100.7%

-1.0% YoY

Months' Supply

2.0 months

+0.4 YoY

Inventory

1,126 units

+27.2% YoY

New Listings

928 homes

+25.6% YoY

Closed Sales

568 homes

+0.7% YoY

Mortgage Rate

6.30%

-0.57% YoY

Recent Headlines

1

Milwaukee Inventory Hits Multi-Year High

Active listings up 27.2% YoY to 1,126 units — highest level on record, yet still well below the 4–6 month balanced market threshold.

2

Mortgage Rates Reach 3-Year Lows

30-yr fixed at 6.30% — NAR notes "housing is the most affordable since March 2022," boosting purchase applications and buyer activity.

3

Milwaukee Outperforms National Market

Local closed sales +0.7% vs. national decline of -8.4%. Local median \$305K vs. national \$396,800 — a 23% affordability advantage.

Sources: RapidStats MLS Reports · Freddie Mac PMMS · NAR Existing Home Sales · BLS LAUS · BLS QCEW · U.S. Census ACS — Milwaukee County, May 2026

NEXT STEPS

Ready to Make Your Move?

Main Takeaways for Buyers

- Rates at 3-yr lows — lock in now for max purchasing power
- More inventory & negotiating leverage than in years

Main Takeaways for Sellers

- Demand is strong — price right and sell quickly
- Staging & condition are your competitive edge

Contact me for a consultation or the full report!

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Schedule Consultation